

AI Data Transformation in Construction Summit Boston 2026-

Panel Discussion

Session Outline:

Title: Building the Business Case: Leadership, Culture, and Data Foundations for AI in Construction

As expectations around productivity, risk management, quality, and safety continue to rise, construction leaders are increasingly challenged to modernize how their organizations operate through data-driven and AI-enabled approaches.

This panel discussion will focus on the cultural, organizational, and technical foundations required to unlock meaningful value from data and AI, and how leaders can champion the transformation.

- Overcoming fragmented data sources and inconsistent data quality remains a major challenge, so what strategies are proving most effective across projects?
- What does it take to build a culture where collecting, sharing, and using data is viewed as valuable rather than burdensome?
- How do you encourage cross-functional collaboration in such a traditionally siloed industry?
- How can leaders be shown the value of data transformation, and how do you make the business case compelling for those focused on cost pressures and short-term delivery?
- What criteria should organizations use to decide which data or AI initiatives to prioritise first?
- As AI becomes more embedded in project delivery, how should construction firms approach risk absorption, particularly around data quality, liability, and decision-making?

Moderator:

Lucas Hendrich, Chief Technology Officer, **Forte Group**

Panelists:

- **Jeffrey Picoraro**, Chief Estimator, **Consigli Construction**
- **Danielle O'Connell**, Vice President, Digital Portfolio & Enablement, **Skanska USA Building**
- **Luke Reeve**, Head of AI Solutions, **TwinKnowledge**
- **Jeff Danley**, Innovation Development Director, **Burns & McDonnell**

Onsite- Session Format:

- You should all meet Mia by the registration desk at the start of the afternoon break, and she will introduce you all to one another as a group – you should all spend ten minutes discussing the panel and ensuring you are all on the same page.
- Tim, our event chair, will announce the moderator, Lucas.
- Lucas will then introduce each panelist by their name, job title and company and welcome each panellist individually to the stage where you will take your seats.
- Each panelist will be given 1 minute to provide a short snappy overview of who you are, your role, organization, and the importance of smart technology or your role. (This is instead of reading out biographies, as a personal introduction is more natural, and the audience are more inclined to listen).
- There will be a table and set of chairs that you will be sat on at the front of the audience with a handheld mic.
- Mia will have a roaming mic so he can move around the room, and the audience can ask questions.
- We want to encourage the audience to ask questions at any time, but Jason will start the line of questioning.

Example Panel Discussion Introduction:

“I am pleased to be moderating this discussion today, and I am happy to introduce you to the following panelists. We have:

- **Jeffrey Picoraro**, Chief Estimator, **Consigli Construction**
- **Danielle O’Connell**, Vice President, Digital Portfolio & Enablement, **Skanska USA Building**
- **Luke Reeve**, Head of AI Solutions, **TwinklKnowledge**
- **Jeff Danley**, Innovation Development Director, **Burns & McDonnell**

If I could ask you to take your seats at the front, please.

Before we start with the line of questioning, I would like to point out that this session is designed for you, the audience, and more importantly to respond to any unanswered questions you may have. So, I would like to encourage you to pose questions and thoughts to the panel and each other. Mia will be stationed around the room with a roaming microphone.

To set the scene, I would like each panellist to provide a quick intro. Who you are, what you do and the importance of digital technology for your role.

Panel Questions

1. Overcoming fragmented data sources and inconsistent data quality remains a major challenge, so what strategies are proving most effective across projects?
2. What does it take to build a culture where collecting, sharing, and using data is viewed as valuable rather than burdensome?
3. How do you encourage cross-functional collaboration in such a traditionally siloed industry?
4. How can leaders be shown the value of data transformation, and how do you make the business case compelling for those focused on cost pressures and short-term delivery?
5. What criteria should organizations use to decide which data or AI initiatives to prioritise first?
6. As AI becomes more embedded in project delivery, how should construction firms approach risk absorption, particularly around data quality, liability, and decision-making?